

Chicago Tribune



\$4.00 | THURSDAY, OCTOBER 8, 2026 | CHICAGOTRIBUNE.COM



AL DIVISION SERIES GAME 3 GUARDIANS 9, WHITE SOX 3



ARMANDO L. SANCHEZ/CHICAGO TRIBUNE

Voting rights groups probed

Feds double down on unproven claims of noncitizens at polls

By Madeleine Ngo, Richard Fausset and Alexandra Berzon
THE NEW YORK TIMES

As the Trump administration promotes doubts about the integrity of the voting system ahead of the midterm elections, Homeland Security officials have investigated more than 150 organizations as part of its effort to scrutinize nonprofits that they say may be helping noncitizens illegally register to vote, according to internal government documents reviewed by The New York Times.

The documents also reveal that the department has considered deploying undercover agents to investigate the organizations. If the groups were found to be recruiting noncitizens for voter registration, the agents could gather evidence and “disrupt activities,” the documents said. The findings could then be used to initiate prosecutions and “dismantle illicit facilitation networks,” according to the documents, which were shared with the Times by Democracy Forward, a legal advocacy organization that received them through a public records request.

The details were included in a June memo providing status updates on the Department of Homeland Security’s “election integrity investigations,” an effort by the Trump administration to find and root out noncitizens who illegally voted or registered to vote.

The problem of noncitizens voting in the United States is a rare one, and there is no credible evidence that it has swayed

See **VOTING** on Page A11

■ Republicans are increasingly anxious that the \$1 billion at their disposal may not be enough to fend off sweeping losses in the coming midterms. **Nation & World, Page B4**

Joy, then Jo

Gareth Mullins reacts after Guardians shortstop Brayan Rocchio scored off a pop-fly during the ninth inning of Game 3 of the AL Division Series against the White Sox at Rate Field on Wednesday in Chicago. Legions of White Sox faithful made the pilgrimage to 35th and Shields for a chance to see a rare series-clincher at home, but Jo Adell’s three-run triple in Cleveland’s four-run third inning spoiled the party for more than 40,000 fans and helped the Guardians fight off elimination. **Coverage in Sports**

For Sox fans, what’s waiting one more day?

By Sam Charles
CHICAGO TRIBUNE

It was the kind of weekday afternoon party that Sox fans dream of. The domestic light beer flowed freely while Italian sausage and hot dogs sizzled on grills under a perfect sunny sky. Fans filled the ballpark dressed mostly in black, drinking in a magical season.

They had arrived hours early. Stereos set up at tailgates cranked dance music, periodically interrupted by a thud on a beanbag board. Scores of fans wore the now-famous “pope hat” given away by the team in August. Several more wore homemade papal robes.

It was 21 years ago this month when a Catholic priest from the

south suburbs attended a White Sox playoff game at U.S. Cellular Field. Much has changed since then. The priest got a bit of a job promotion and the ballpark was renamed, more than once.

Has it all been divine intervention? Maybe. Wednesday morning, video surfaced on social media showing the priest — now Pope Leo XIV — giving a thumbs-up to

people wearing White Sox gear while visiting Rome.

“As a Catholic, it’s fun to say that,” said Dan Kozlowski of Crown Point, Indiana, who sported a homemade pope hat at the game. But he also gave credit to the team’s young core on the field.

“I don’t want to take anything

See **SOX** on Page A7

ELECTION 2026 GOVERNOR

Corbett’s journey to the center

Former GOP strategist hopes to attract those abandoned by party

By Dan Petrella
CHICAGO TRIBUNE

After Illinois Democrats trounced Republicans in the last midterm election, political consultant Collin Corbett had a message for fellow members of the GOP.

Pointing to exit polling commissioned by his firm, Cor Strategies, Corbett argued his party’s latest drubbing wasn’t because Illinois had become an uber-liberal bastion. It was largely because Republicans had ceded the political center, home to almost 40% of Illinois voters who identified as “moderate,” a share similar to what Associated Press polling also found in 2022.

“The Republican strategy of screaming ‘the sky is falling’ and ‘all is lost’ is clearly not working,”



Collin Corbett, center, stands next to his wife, Abbey, and speaks with supporters Michael Berthold, left, and Marilynyn and Bruce Plaxton during a fundraising event at the Long Story Short Pub on Sept. 30 in Barrington. Corbett is running for governor as an Independent. **STACEY WESCOTT/CHICAGO TRIBUNE**

Corbett wrote in a blog post that year. “The voters in this state aren’t hyper-partisans or (ideologues). They just want things to get done — they’re not interested in the drama and hyperbole.”

Four years later, Corbett has stopped trying to convince Republicans to tack to the center and instead is testing his theory himself with a long-shot independent bid for governor. The 40-year-old Palatine resident is the first independent candidate in 16 years to qualify for the general election ballot for governor, and

only the third in the past century, according to state election records.

Despite his campaign slogan, “Hope for Illinois,” Corbett acknowledges he has little realistic hope of upsetting Democratic Gov. JB Pritzker, a billionaire Hyatt Hotels heir who restocked his campaign fund with \$65 million in August, or Republican nominee Darren Bailey, the conservative former lawmaker from southern Illinois who lost to Pritzker by almost 13 percentage points in

See **CORBETT** on Page A2

ELECTION 2026 SCHOOL BOARD PRESIDENT

Mayor reaffirms support for embattled Dominguez

Progressive candidate faces new investigation into alleged sexual misconduct with teen girl

By Alice Yin and Kate Armanini
CHICAGO TRIBUNE

Mayor Brandon Johnson reiterated his support Wednesday for a candidate for Chicago Board of Education president accused of sexually harassing a minor in 2017, saying Hilario Dominguez’s progressive values are “separate” from a reopened misconduct investigation into the allegations.

Speaking at a City Hall news conference, Johnson made clear he still backs the former deputy political director for the Chicago Teachers Union. Dominguez has denied any misconduct.

“Look, I do support Hilario Dominguez,” the mayor said.

“The stakes are incredibly high. I think it’s important that we have people in office who understand that our values have to be front and center, particularly our values as it relates to how we invest in our public education.”

Asked multiple times whether he knew about these allegations before news broke of the Chicago Public Schools Office of the Inspector General reopening the investigation into the case, Johnson said “the information that’s available has always been available.”

And pressed on whether the red line he and Dominguez share against school closures is more

See **CPS** on Page A5

“I think it’s important that we have people in office who understand that our values have to be front and center, particularly our values as it relates to how we invest in our public education.”

MAYOR BRANDON JOHNSON

SUBSCRIPTION

Visit myaccount.chicagotribune.com or call 312-546-7900 to sign up for a subscription. To place an ad, visit placeanad.chicagotribune.com.

WEATHER FORECAST

TODAY H: 71 L: 51
FRI. H: 70 L: 59
SAT. H: 80 L: 62
FULL WEATHER REPORT PAGE A10

INDEX

Almanac A11
Arts & Living B7
Comics B12-B13
Crossword B13
Editorials A8
Horoscope B12
Nation & World B4
Obituaries A11
Television B11

179th year No. 281
© Chicago Tribune

